

Introduction: Absorption Hold-Check

What, how, why · Martin Ignatov, PM Trading Products · 25 Sep 2026

The problem

A large educator partner teaches students to watch for **absorption**: a big resting order that keeps absorbing aggressive market orders without letting price through. It's their best reversal spot, but they spot it by eye and miss about half. They want Bookmap to **flag it on the heatmap and ping them**, tuned for **ES and CL**, before their cohort starts in **6 weeks**, and credited as their method.

Absorption is core signal and Bookmap **already ships an Absorption indicator** (desktop, Global+) that has sound and Telegram alerts. So the gap isn't a missing alert. It's that today's tool measures *volume*, not *absorption*, it is hard to set up, and there are known issues with alerts:

- Its rule (volume at a price within a window) **keeps counting after price trades through**, so it can't tell a level that held from one that broke.
- Thresholds need re-tuning per instrument and time of day, and there are no ES/CL presets.
- Alerts need a self-built Telegram bot, and the Knowledge Base lists known alert defects.
- It's desktop-only.

Third-party add-ons exist, too, but at extra cost - Absorption Hunter (\$29/mo) and Absorption Indicator QSD (\$10/mo).

How we solve it

A **Hold-Check mode** for the same indicator (Classic stays unchanged):

1. **Detect.** Enough volume trades into a resting price to look like absorption, but it only counts once the level proves itself: it has to hold for a few seconds (**3s ES, 5s CL**) without giving back more than a brief 1-tick poke that price immediately takes back (**CL uses a 3-tick range since its book is thinner**). A quick breakout right after the volume hits never triggers an alert.
2. **Show.** A zone on the heatmap follows each event to **Reacting → Held ✓** or **Broken ✗**, so traders learn from outcomes.
3. **Ping.** Alerts work with zero setup: a pop-up, a sound, and a browser notification. They're capped so a noisy stretch can't spam you, and they only fire during each preset's trading hours. Desktop keeps its own alert system in Phase 2.
4. **Tune.** ES/CL presets with one simple Low/Medium/High sensitivity dial instead of a dozen raw settings, plus two ready-to-use templates — **“«Partner» ES” and “«Partner» CL” — pre-loaded with per-instrument starting values so cohort students need zero setup**. That's how their method gets credit; the feature isn't named after them.

Delivery.

- **Week 1:** a temporary fix while the real build is underway — we manually set up today's existing desktop tool for the partner's own ES/CL trading, so she has something working right away.
- **Week 6:** the real web version is in the cohort's hands 5 working days before day 1 — web.bookmap.com is Bookmap's target platform for this. An MVP, plus a list of what we'd cut first if we run behind schedule and have to make trade-offs.
- **Phase 2:** the same logic added to today's desktop Absorption indicator too, plus order-level detection and push notifications.

The prototype runs this same detection logic, tested against a set of worked examples that all have to pass.

Who it's for

- **Partner educator:** may run her own trading on desktop, but teaches live to a cohort who should see identical marks whatever they're on.
- **Cohort students:** new users, mostly without MBO, often on a laptop browser rather than a full trading rig. Zero configuration, zero install, the educator's exact marks.
- **Active futures traders** on web.bookmap.com: fewer alerts on levels that break, alerts without setup.

Product environment

- **Primary user:** a cohort student on web.bookmap.com, often on a laptop browser rather than a multi-monitor rig — sometimes watching the educator's live stream in one tab while running their own ES/CL chart in another. They expect the exact setup just shown to them, with nothing to configure. The feature runs alongside everything else they're doing, so alerts have to reach them passively (sound, browser notification) rather than demand they stare at one chart.
- **Educator:** live on stream, teaching in real time. The mark needs to appear on her chart automatically so she can narrate the reaction, not stop to configure something on air.
- **Why server-side:** one engine per instrument, shared by every viewer, is what makes this environment work — the whole cohort watching ES together doesn't multiply compute, and nobody needs a desktop app open or anything configured to see the same signal the educator sees.
- **Plans:** ES data comes from CME, CL from NYMEX — we still need to confirm the web app can access CME and NYMEX future data. Absorption needs the Global+ plan on desktop today; whether web will require the same plan is also an open question.

Business value

- **Channel.** Educator cohorts drive growth. A cohort taught on a native Bookmap feature has a reason to subscribe and stay.
- **Retention.** It fixes a feature Global+ users already pay for.
- **Competitive parity.** ATAS, Quantower and DeepCharts have similar absorption, power trades, and DeepDOM indicators.
- **Leverage.** The same spec and test suite carry over when this comes to desktop later; the same server engine already runs alongside Market Pulse Web's other tools. Order-level (MBO) support is a future upsell.
- **Value** ≈ cohort size × trial→paid × (plan + data) × months retained, plus the uplift for existing users, against development cost for 6 weeks. **Defer** if past cohorts were under 50 students or converted under ~10%.
- **Numbers still needed:** cohort sizes and conversion (affiliate and billing data); Absorption usage and alert-enable rate; share of ES/CL and MBO users (session data).